

Glyceryl Thioglycolate



What is it?

Glyceryl thioglycolate (GTG) is the key ingredient in most salon permanent wave solutions. This is used to curl or straighten (reverse perm) the hair. These permanents are called acid or heat perms. They are different from older cold waves, which do not use GTG.

A permanent wave process with GTG usually requires 3 containers of fluid.

After the hair is curled or straightened using this chemical, GTG *remains* on the hair for 3 to 6 months. To reduce a reaction, it may be helpful to cut the treated hair short. Washing the hair with alkaline tincture of green soap may also be helpful.

GLYCERYL THIOGLYCOLATE can also be known as:

- Glyceryl monothioglycolate
- Glycerol monomercaptoacetate
- Mercaptoacetic acid monoester with 1,2,3 - propanetriol
- Glycerol monothioglycolate
- Acid permanent wave

Some Possible Uses of GLYCERYL THIOGLYCOLATE / Where it might be found:

- Permanent wave solution

What should I do to avoid GLYCERYL THIOGLYCOLATE?

Avoid acid and heat perms. A safe choice is the cysteamine hydrochloride perm (e.g. Iso Option 2 and Goldwell Definition h2/s perm). Hair permed

with them does not produce a reaction, and they do not penetrate latex gloves.

Older "cold waves" rarely cause allergic reactions, since they use *ammonium* thioglycolate. They are, however, more irritating.

Another type of home perm that is safe but yields a slower and weaker curl is the sulfite wave.

Hairdressers who are allergic may show a reaction to the perm solution as well as to hair that has been recently permed.

Gloves must be worn when shampooing and cutting hair that has been recently treated with GTG. However, GTG readily passes through rubber gloves. The only gloves protective against GTG are:

- Plastic laminate glove (i.e. 4H glove by Allerderm; www.allerderm.com)
- Barrier chemical glove (by Ansell, www.ansellpro.com).

A snug rubber glove may be worn over the top to improve precision.

GTG often spills onto things during mixing and application. It is important to rinse all sinks, surfaces, faucet taps, instruments, and telephones after GTG is used.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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